Rachel Carson



Born in 1907, Rachel Carson grew up on a farm in Pennsylvania, where she developed a love of nature. She won a scholarship to Pennsylvania College for Women and later gained a masters in zoology. Growing up in a land-locked state, Carson dreamed of the ocean; it became an enduring passion, and she went to work as an aquatic biologist with the US Fish and Wildlife Service (FWS).

Carson wrote and published many educational brochures and eventually became the US Fish and Wildlife Service's editor-in-chief. From 1941 onward, she wrote books about marine biology, most notably *The Sea Around Us*, which won the National Book Award, and was a national best seller. This success enabled Carson to write full time and she began work on *Silent Spring* in 1958. In 1960, Carson was diagnosed with breast cancer; she died in 1964.

Key works

1941 *Under the Sea Wind*

1951 *The Sea Around Us*

1955 *The Edge of the Sea*

1962 *Silent Spring*

Dying wildlife

Like many great and influential works, *Silent Spring* began in a very personal way. In January 1958, Carson's friend Olga Huckins sent her a